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MOHAMMAD ATTENDS LIVE DEMONSTRATION OF UNITREE G1 ROBOT

■ His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday met with a number of local dignitaries at Al Madaif Majlis in Union House in Dubai. Shaikh Mohammad also attended a live demonstration of the Unitree G1 robot by Dubai Future Labs. The lightweight, highly balanced robot mimics human movement and represents the latest in robotics and AI.

RTA to link Etihad Rail stations with buses, metro

Connection with public transport networks promises faster, easier journeys

DUBAI
BY ASHFAQ AHMED
Senior Assistant Editor

The Roads and Transport Authority (RTA) of Dubai is spearheading efforts to fully integrate upcoming Etihad Rail passenger stations in Dubai with the city's existing public transport network.

Ahmad Hashim Bahrozian, CEO of the RTA's Public Transport Agency, confirmed that every new Etihad Rail station will be linked directly to feeder buses and taxis, ensuring seamless last-mile access for commuters.

"We are replicating the successful model used for the Dubai Metro including the Expo Link and the upcoming Blue Line, where feeder buses enhance rail

INTEGRATION

- **Dubai Station:** Linked directly with the Dubai Metro, RTA buses, and taxis
- **Abu Dhabi Station:** Served by city routes and public buses
- **Sharjah and Fujairah Stations:** Easily accessible via local public transport terminals

connectivity," Bahrozian told *Gulf News*. "This approach will connect Etihad Rail stations to local communities and Dubai Metro stations alike, facilitating smooth transfers between multiple transport modes," he added. He said the passengers in Dubai will have easy access to the Etihad Rail stations with feeder buses, metro links and taxis.

Set to launch passenger services in 2026, Etihad Rail marks a landmark development in the

UAE's transport infrastructure. By linking rail stations with feeder buses and taxis, Dubai is setting a new standard for efficient, eco-friendly, and passenger-centric transport.

Connecting 11 cities

The 900km Etihad Rail passenger network will connect 11 cities across all seven emirates, from Al Sila in Abu Dhabi's west to Fujairah on the east coast, bringing the UAE's emirates closer than ever through fast, reliable, and fully integrated travel options.

To maximise convenience, full integration with Dubai's metro and bus systems will be implemented. This comprehensive connectivity will enable easy, hassle-free transfers between trains, metro, buses, and taxis reducing travel times and costs for passengers.

Etihad Rail and the RTA have partnered to allow passengers to use their existing nol cards across the entire rail and public transport system.

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Trump slaps additional 25% tariffs on India

NEW LEVY OVER RUSSIAN OIL IMPORTS DOUBLES TARIFFS ON INDIA TO 50%

DUBAI
BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

US President Donald Trump has signed an executive order imposing an additional 25 per cent tariff on Indian imports, citing India's continued purchase of Russian crude oil, the White House confirmed yesterday — a move that significantly escalates trade tensions between the two countries.

The new levy will take effect in three weeks and comes on top of a separate 25 per cent tariff set to take effect today — effectively doubling the tariff rate on Indian goods to 50 per cent.

The measures were detailed in a White House statement titled "Addressing Threats to the United States by the Government of the Russian Federation." Trump cited national security and foreign policy concerns, alleging that India's imports of Russian oil — directly or indirectly — pose an "unusual and extraordinary threat" to the US.

The executive order maintains exemptions for certain sector-specific imports, including steel, aluminium, and pharmaceuticals. It also notes that Indian goods already in transit or meeting specific criteria will be exempt from the additional duties.

The measures were detailed in a White House statement titled 'Addressing Threats to the United States by the Government of the Russian Federation'.

Imports falling under the new tariff order must meet stringent US customs requirements, including classification under "privileged foreign status" when entering designated foreign trade zones.

The order also grants the US President flexibility to revise or revoke the measures in response to shifting geopolitical dynamics, potential retaliatory actions by trading partners, or changes in Russia's or India's trade behaviour.

Can the rate be adjusted?

The order provides scope for adjustments, depending on evolving conditions, such as retaliatory actions by other countries or diplomatic steps taken by Russia or India to address the declared national emergency. "Accordingly, and as consistent with applicable law, articles of India imported into the customs territory of the United States shall be subject to an additional ad valorem rate of duty of 25 per cent," the order stated.

— with inputs from agencies
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SPORT
Dubai always a special place for me, Rory McIlroy says | P13

Police nab group offering fake traffic fine discounts

Suspects were using stolen credit card data to commit fraud

DUBAI
BY NATHANIEL LACSINA
Senior Web Editor

Dubai Police have arrested a group of fraudsters who were running a deceptive social media campaign offering fake discounts of 30 per cent to 70 per cent on traffic fines, in a scam that exploited stolen bank card information.

The suspects lured victims through fraudulent advertisements claiming they could help reduce traffic fines through 'special channels.'

In reality, the group was using stolen credit card data to

pay the full amount of traffic fines online. After the payment appeared successful, the fraudsters would collect half the value in cash from the victims, portraying it as a discounted settlement.

Investigations revealed the group obtained stolen banking details through cyber scams or purchased them via illegal marketplaces. The process often involved meeting victims in person, requesting the total fine amount in cash, then paying it using compromised cards — making the payment seem legitimate in the government system.

Dubai Police emphasised that this scheme constitutes a dual criminal offence: both theft of financial data and fraudulent misrepresentation.

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